



NYC events, *sifted* just for you.

A taste-first event app for young New Yorkers. Live in NYC. Already learning.

THE SIFT TEAM · SPRING 2026

Sift is a taste-first event app for young NYC. Already shipping, already learning.

THE PROBLEM

Discovery is broken. 87% juggle 3+ apps.

Across 20 user interviews, the recurring theme: "I don't want another social media app. I just want to know what's good this weekend."

OUR SOLUTION

A taste graph that ranks every NYC event for you.

Sift curates with AI plus an editor (rejecting 85% of incoming inventory), users swipe one card at a time, and the deck re-ranks in real time. **Taste, swipe, plan.**

WHERE WE ARE

Live on the App Store. 18.3% conversion post-launch.

21 organic downloads, 30 signups, 21 actively engaged, 69 on the waitlist. ~2.6× Apple's typical product-page benchmark with no paid acquisition. Catalog refreshed every 3 days from 6 live sources.

THE ASK

\$750K SAFE. 18 months. NYC end-to-end.

Funds iOS and Android launch, push-notification engine, and the curator/creator partnerships that drive growth. **\$345M ARR opportunity in NYC alone.**



02 · THE CHANGE

TODAY

**You open *six apps* and
stay home.**

TOMORROW

**You open Sift and *your
night plans itself.***

NYC's event industry is enormous and the discovery problem is unsolved. The first taste graph for events wins the city, and the category.

NYC has infinite events. Nothing is actually personalized.

87%

of people we interviewed use 3+ apps to find things to do
(Eventbrite, TimeOut, IG, Resy, etc.)

0

interview subjects asked for *another social feed*. They want answers, not another timeline.

"We spend most of our time looking into activities we end up not even going to. We just get overwhelmed and give up."

— Sam, 23. One of 20 user interviews.

"Honestly? I don't want another social media app. I just want to know what's good this weekend."

— Recurring theme across 20 interviews.

The conditions for a taste graph just landed. The window is open today.

A taste graph is a model that learns what you like from how you react. Spotify, Beli, and TikTok proved the pattern. Three shifts converge in 2026; none existed five years ago, and the incumbents haven't responded.

AI curation got cheap

An LLM rubric that scores 1,000 events for audience fit costs <\$5/wk. The same job needed a five-person editorial team in 2020. We have it running today.

Swipe-to-rate trained a generation

Beli, Spotify, and TikTok proved the model. **Events haven't caught up.**

Aggregators are stale

Eventbrite hasn't shipped a meaningful UX change in 5 years. Editorial sites still publish by hand. None personalize. The window is open *now*.

Sift curates. You swipe. It learns.

Every swipe re-ranks your deck in real time.

1

Discover

One curated card at a time.
The deck is shaped by your
taste, not who you follow.

2

Learn

Three intents per swipe.
Right is going, left is not now,
down is not interested. Each
one teaches a different
signal. Re-rank in real time.

3

Import

Paste an Instagram or TikTok
link, or share-sheet directly
into Sift. AI extracts the event
and adds it to the catalog.
Users feed the moat.

4

Plan

Save, sequence the night,
one tap to Apple or Google
Calendar. From swipe to
"added to my Saturday" in
under 30 seconds.

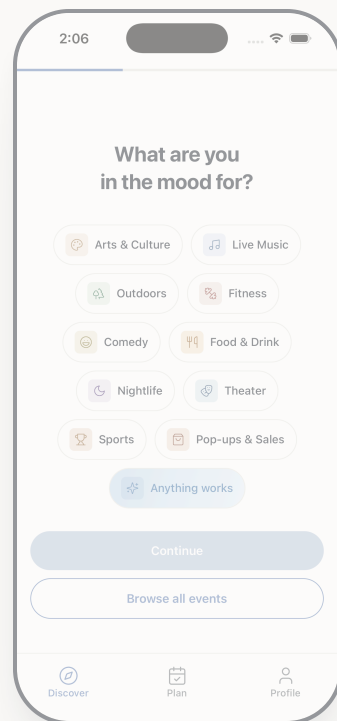
Open it. Tune it. Swipe. *Import.*



OPEN

Find your vibe

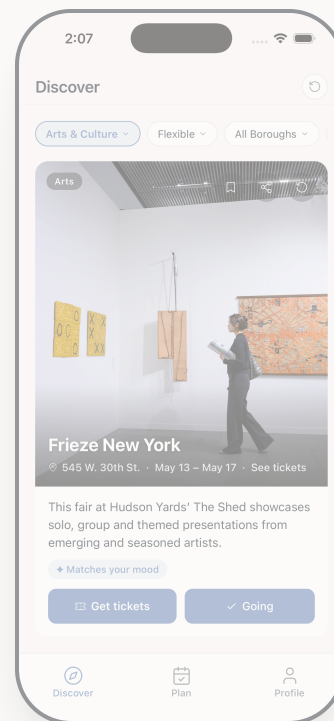
Taste-first event app, built for NYC.



TUNE

Pick a mood

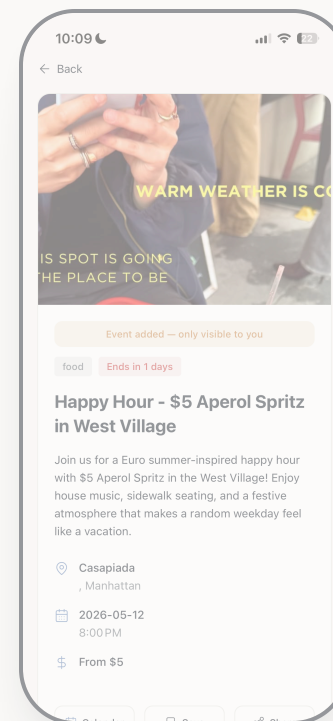
One tap seeds the deck. Or pick "anything works" and let the swipes do it.



SWIPE

Right · Left · Down

Three intents per card. Real NYC events. Frieze, not salsa night at a hotel bar.



IMPORT

Paste a link

IG & TikTok event posts become Sift events in seconds. AI fills in venue, date, price, ticket URL.

We're already pulling NYC's catalog in real time.



DICE



RESIDENT ADVISOR



LUMA

fever

FEVER



NYC MUSEUMS



EVENTBRITE

Every 3 days

auto-refresh via GitHub Actions

11 categories

arts, music, comedy, food, nightlife,
sports, more

Vibe 1–10

LLM-scored, sub-5 suppressed

AI + human

rubric does the cut, editor reviews the
keep-pile

Six live scrapers ingest every 3 days. *AI rejects tourist traps, corporate spam, and kids events.* *The keep-pile gets vibe-scored 1–10 by an LLM rubric.* **Sub-5 never loads in the feed.**

Curate hard. Score every signal. Every swipe re-ranks the deck.

Step 1 · Curate

Six live sources. Refreshed every 3 days.

- **AI ingest** from Dice, Resident Advisor, Luma, Fever, NYC museums, Eventbrite.
- **Claude Sonnet 4.6 with web search** finds what the scrapers miss. Pop-ups. Sample sales. Openings.
- **Editor signs off on the keep-pile.** Eventbrite needs the firehose. We don't.

Step 2 · Score

An LLM scores audience fit. The cut is automated.

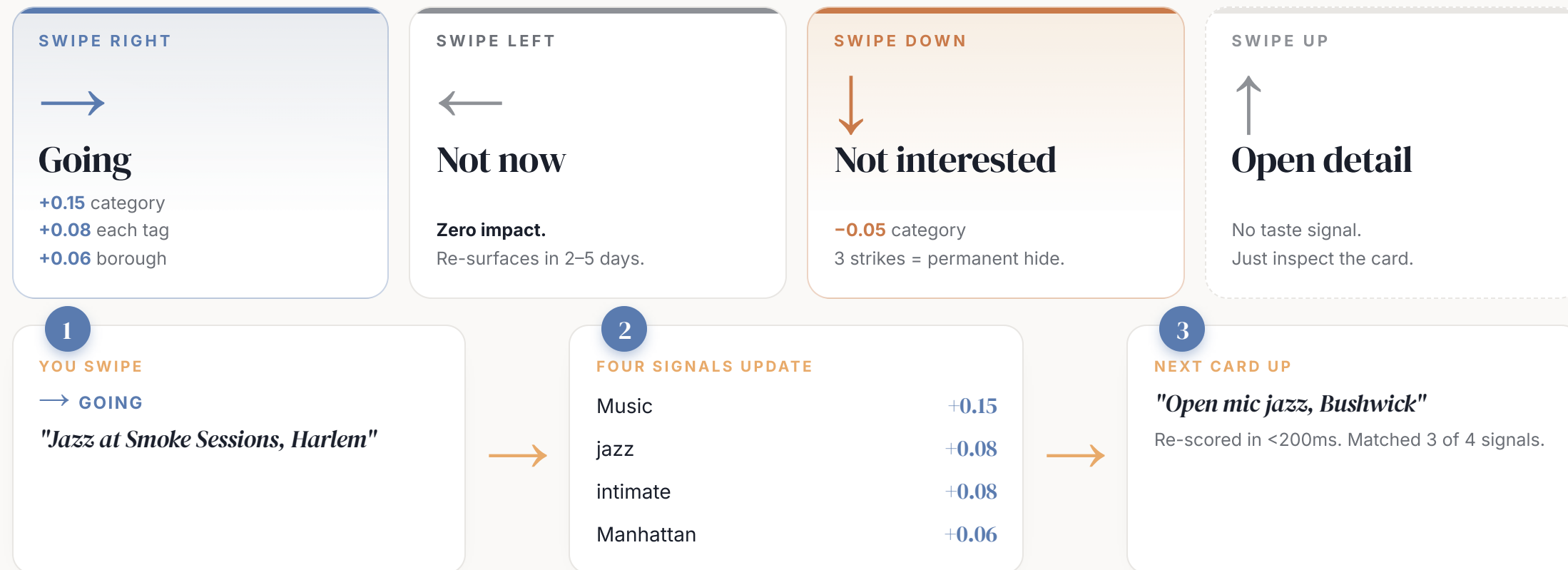
- **Vibe 1–10** by gpt-4o-mini. **Sub-5 never loads.**
- **Category re-classified** at >0.8 confidence. Sample sales don't get filed under nightlife.
- **Tags, venue, price band, geography** all scored per event.

Step 3 · Swipe

Every swipe re-ranks the deck.

- **Three intents.** Right is going. Left is not now. Down is not interested.
- **Four signals update per swipe.** Category, tag, borough, price.
- **Re-rank in <200ms.** Cold-start blends quality+timing for ~20 swipes, then fully personalizes.
- Permanent hide after 3 hard passes.
See next slide for the full loop.

Three intents. Four signals.



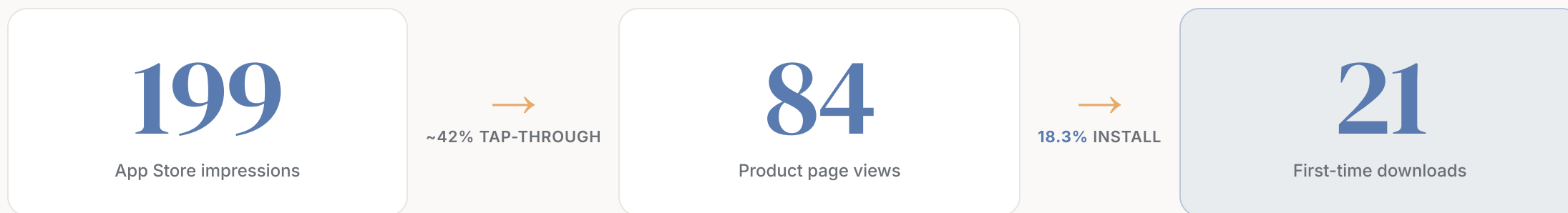
Cold start. Personalization warms up over your first ~20 swipes.

Taste. Taste. Taste.

We're the only taste play.

	CURATED	EDITORIAL	PERSONALIZED	ONE-TAP TO PLAN
Eventbrite / Dice VOLUME	X firehose	X	X	X
TimeOut / Infatuation EDITORIAL	✓ static	✓	X	X
Group chat PERSONALIZED	✓ by friends	X	✓ social	X texts
Sift TASTE	✓ AI + editor	✓ via partners	✓ real-time	✓ calendar export

18.3% App Store conversion. Zero spend. Zero paid acquisition.



Apple's typical product-page conversion is **~5–7%**. Sift converts at **~2.6× the benchmark** with no paid acquisition. **3,544 tracked engagement events, 30 signups, 21 actively engaged, 69 on the waitlist.**

Catalog cadence sped up.

Weekly refresh became every 3 days. More fresh inventory, less stale recs.

iOS share extension live.

Sift sits in every NYC user's IG and TikTok share sheet. Distribution wedge that incumbents don't have.

Two lanes. Both compound on top of the taste graph.

NEAR-TERM

Affiliate fees

5–15% per ticket and reservation routed through Sift. Dice and Eventbrite are already in the catalog as scrapers.

Affiliate revenue activates when we wire Resy and Ticketmaster. Zero ad inventory. Paid only on conversion.

TARGETED Activates Q3 2026

MID-TERM

Sponsored placements & curation

Brands, venues, and editorial partners pay to run native lists inside the right curated decks. Eater, Infatuation, and top NYC creators are the partnership target once user base passes 10K. **Native, not banner.**

TARGETED Activates at 10K MAU

Taste graph compounds → *placements get more valuable* → *partners pay more.*

\$345M ARR in NYC. *\$1.4B+* across the top 5 metros.

STEP 1	NYC residents aged 18–35	3.0M
STEP 2	× 50% target band (<i>active spenders</i>)	1.5M
STEP 3	× 30% reachable in 5 yrs	450K
STEP 4	× \$200/wk going-out spend	\$4.7B GMV
NYC SOM	× ~7% blended take	\$345M

The playbook ports.

NYC	\$345M
LA	\$290M
Chicago	\$180M
Miami	\$150M
SF Bay	\$200M
TOP-5 ARR	~\$1.4B+

City-agnostic rubric. Only the keep-pile lead changes per city.

Taste graph compounds. Every NYC swipe informs the cold-start in LA.

One editorial lead per city. Not one per genre.

Top-5 figures are next-step expansion estimates, not committed plan. NYC is the wedge.

Three phases. Each one earns the right to the next.

PHASE 1 · NOW → Q3 2026

Win NYC core

- Friends-of-friends and creator seeding (Tier-2 NYC TikTok).
- Curator partnership outreach: Eater and Infatuation lists inside the app.
- Referral loop: invite a friend, both unlock a list.
- Press: NY Mag, The Cut, Brooklyn Mag launch coverage.

Target: **10K MAU, 30% W4 retention, early CAC indicators.**

PHASE 2 · Q4 2026 → Q2 2027

Scale NYC, scope city #2

- Push-notification engine: weekend pickups and drop alerts.
- Affiliate revenue turns on (Resy and Ticketmaster live).
- Paid social only after creator content proves LTV/CAC > 3.
- **Second-city playbook scoped, editorial lead recruited in parallel.** LA is the lead candidate.

Target: **75K MAU NYC, \$40K MRR, second-city editorial lead hired.**

PHASE 3 · 2027+

Own NYC, launch city #2, sequence cities 3–5

- NYC fully owned: 250K MAU, deep editorial moat.
- **City #2 (LA) goes live** once NYC unit economics hit target.
- **Cities 3–5 (Chicago, Miami, SF Bay) sequenced** at six-month intervals.
- Sponsored placements compounding. Affiliate revenue scaling on Resy and Ticketmaster.

Target: **NYC dominance · \$4M ARR run-rate · city #2 live · 3 more in flight.**

Quarter-by-quarter plan. Funded entirely by this round.

Q2 2026 · NOW

App Store live + polish

- iOS shipped, share extension live
- Three-intent swipe + social import
- Catalog refresh every 3 days
- 30 signups · 21 active → 1K NYC users

Q3 2026

Android, revenue, scout city #2

- Android app launch
- Resy and Ticketmaster affiliate fees live
- Hire NYC editorial + growth lead
- **Second-city scouting begins (LA shortlist).**
- 1K → 10K NYC users

Q4 2026

NYC depth, recruit city #2 lead

- First sponsored curator placements live
- Editorial partnerships deepen with Eater + Infatuation
- **Second-city editorial lead recruited.**
- 10K → 75K NYC users, \$40K MRR

Q1-Q2 2027

Own NYC, ship city #2, Series A

- NYC dominance, sponsored revenue compounding
- **City #2 goes live; cities 3-5 sequenced.**
- \$4M ARR run-rate, A-ready metrics
- Series A target: \$5-8M to fund cities 3-5

What could break this, and exactly what we do about it.

RISK 01 · DISTRIBUTION

Cold-start beyond friends-of-friends.

Every event app that's tried social has died bootstrapping the network. Paid acquisition without payback kills runway.

MITIGATION

Creator + curator seeding, not paid social.

Eater and Infatuation curate inside the app; their audience is already ours. Referral unlocks lists. Paid social only after LTV/CAC > 3 on validated creator content.

RISK 02 · CATALOG SCALING

Hand-curation doesn't scale to 5 cities.

The 85% reject rate depends on a human reviewer. Hiring 5 editorial leads is slow and expensive.

MITIGATION

One editorial lead per city. Same playbook.

The AI rubric does 90% of the cut; the human reviews the keep-pile (~30 min/wk). One lead per city is the model. City-agnostic rubric is the moat.

RISK 03 · INCUMBENT RESPONSE

Eventbrite or TikTok ships a "for you" feed.

If a giant copies the loop, our window closes.

MITIGATION

Their model can't reject the firehose.

Eventbrite's economics need 100% inventory live. TikTok ranks creators, not events. The taste graph compounds; by month 6 the model is the moat.

Builders who live the problem. Target demographic, in the product daily.

Four builders who live the problem, in the product daily. This round buys focused product velocity: Android launch, sponsored placement infrastructure, and the curator/creator partnerships that drive growth.



Yi-Jie Cheng



Jary Tolentino



Irene Nam



Jerry Gu

\$750K SAFE. 18 months runway. Every dollar is line-itemed.

40%

Engineering and product. iOS and Android launch, push-notification engine, automated ingest, sponsored placement infrastructure.

\$300K**30%**

Catalog and curation. Content licensing, weekly curator stipends, editorial review tooling.

\$225K**20%**

Marketing and growth. Creator seeding, app-store assets, referral mechanics. *No paid social until LTV/CAC > 3.*

\$150K**10%**

Operations. Legal, infra, accounting, contractor coverage.

\$75K

BY Q2 2027

What this round buys

- ✓ **NYC: 41 today → 75K MAU.**
- ✓ **Android shipped Q3 2026.** iOS already live.
- ✓ **Affiliate revenue compounding** with Resy + Ticketmaster.
- ✓ **Sponsored placements live** with NYC editorial partners.
- ✓ **Social-import distribution wedge scaled.** IG + TikTok share extension.
- ✓ **City #2 editorial lead hired** and playbook scoped.
- ✓ **\$40K MRR run-rate.** A-round-ready metrics by Q2 2027.



\$750K to make NYC *unmissable.*

\$750K SAFE · 18 months runway · funds iOS and Android launch, push-notification engine, sponsored placement infrastructure, and owning NYC end-to-end before any second city.

NYC's event industry is enormous and the discovery problem is unsolved. Sift makes sure you actually go to the right ones, and is the first taste graph for events.

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS?

TRY SIFT TONIGHT



Scan to install

SIFT · APP STORE